Proponent's Argument

MAYOR LURIE & SUPERMAJORITY OF SUPERVISORS SAY YES ON PROP A TO CLEAN UP OUR OUTDATED CHARTER.

About every 30 years, City Hall sets aside its differences to clean up old, broken, and conflicting parts of our city's governing document called the city charter.

Department heads, commissions, and the public suggest changes through a transparent, months-long process. The mayor and a supermajority of the Board of Supervisors agreed on 110 small fixes that will help city government serve you better.

The fixes fall into four categories:

OUTDATED TECHNOLOGY
New technology can make old laws pointless. For example, the current system still requires the city to employ a bookbinder and to publish laws in daily print editions of the Chronicle that no longer exist.

WASTEFUL DUPLICATION
Sometimes two city departments are required to do the exact same job. For example, multiple departments being required to create the same report, forcing employees into busy work that wastes time and money.

ZOMBIE COMMISSIONS
Our bureaucracy has 60 advisory bodies and commissions that can't be updated without a vote at the ballot. After decades the charter can end up with zombie commissions that serve no purpose. For example, the Sanitation and Streets Commission oversees a department that doesn't exist, and the charter still references a Parking Authority that voters removed a decade ago.

CONFUSING OR BADLY WORDED LAWS
Lawmakers sometimes make typos and mistakes when writing legislation, leaving behind laws that are confusing or just don't make sense. Prop A cleans up some of the worst examples.

VOTE YES ON PROP A THE CITYWIDE GOOD GOVERNMENT CONSENSUS MEASURE

Mayor Daniel Lurie
Board of Supervisors President Rafael Mandelman
Supervisor Alan Wong
Supervisor Bilal Mahmood
Supervisor Chyanne Chen
Supervisor Danny Sauter
Supervisor Matt Dorsey
Supervisor Myrna Melgar
Supervisor Steven Sherrill
State Senator Scott Wiener
Assemblywoman Catherine Stefani
Assemblyman Matt Haney

Rebuttal to Proponent's Argument

A love letter to San Francisco

What makes San Francisco special? Is it the views, the hills, the parks, the food, the victorians? A big part of what is special about San Francisco is San Franciscans. We are active and informed. We stand up for what we believe in! We get involved in the things we are passionate about. We believe in flourishing democracies. Prop A is taking a lot of that away.

A healthy democracy requires a balance of power. A healthy government has plenty of citizen participation. Debate leads us to the best answers. These are all reasons to vote No on A.

Our current city government as represented by our elected officials is primarily monolithic, representing monied and corporate interests, whether couched in suave niceties or smug indifference.

They are trying to take away much of what makes San Francisco special. They all go along with each other, no matter how bad the idea is, as long as Trump's billionaires benefit.

When you boil it down, today's San Francisco needs to protect people power more than ever.

Reject the power grab. No SF Kings.

Vote No on A and while you're at it, Vote No on D E and F.

Coalition on Homelessness

Arguments are the opinions of the authors and have not been checked for accuracy by any official agency.
Arguments are printed as submitted. Spelling and grammatical errors have not been corrected.

Opponent's Argument

The charter should be improved, but not at the expense of transparency, and checks on government power. There are grievous mistakes in Prop A that threaten participatory democracy by removing commissions put in place by voters.

Take independent oversight for November 2018 Proposition C. The measure allows the Board of Supervisors to remove independent oversight with a majority vote. Prop C, "Our City, Our Home", is a deeply vetted people's initiative placed on the ballot by Coalition on Homelessness alongside over 700 housed/unhoused volunteers and supported by 215,491 voters. It is a tax on mega corporations to fund homeless solutions. Due to careful planning by the oversight body, the fund has housed over 8,400 people, including 2,800 children, thousands prevented from becoming homeless, and receiving behavioral health treatment services.

Rising rents up and down the west coast have skyrocketed homelessness. Unlike west coast cities without a local revenue measure, SF has seen a steady decline in street homelessness. Portland saw an enourmous 67% increase and San Diego a 26% increase in 2024. SF was poised to see exploding homelessness due to the pandemic, but planning by the oversight body staved that off.

While Prop C has been wildly successful, progress is at risk. Rising rents create a dire need for using funds to permanently solve and prevent homelessness. The oversight body is charged with digging into data and centering unhoused people's needs including hidden needs of homeless children. Each year they struggle against Mayoral Administrations who favor ruling by sound bites, and shiny failed quick fixes over data driven proven solutions.

Prop A attempts to silence the voices of homeless people and their allies that challenge power, and this particular body was targeted only because of its effectiveness in doing so.

No on A.

Coalition on Homelessness

Rebuttal to Opponent's Argument

Prop A is a good government housekeeping measure that cleans up and modernizes San Francisco's lengthy, outdated charter to serve you better.

Currently five separate, overlapping commissions oversee homeless services in San Francisco. None of them are removed by Prop A.

But right now, even small administrative updates to some of these commissions — like adjusting how often they meet, or the qualifications of their members — have to go before voters as a ballot measure.

Making such routine updates should not be delayed through an entire election cycle or require hundreds of thousands of dollars in campaign costs. Prop A lets the Board handle those small fixes through ordinary legislation instead.

Requiring a citywide election to fix a typo or fix outdated language isn't democracy, it just makes City Hall less accountable for delivering results for voters.

Join us as we make San Francisco's charter serve you better!

VOTE YES ON PROP A — THE GOOD GOVERNMENT CONSENSUS MEASURE

Board of Supervisors President Rafael Mandelman
Mayor Daniel Lurie

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